



US agrees to lift ZTE ban

A report from Reuters says that ZTE and the US govt have reached a deal to get ZTE back in business in the US. <https://dgit.in/jun18-A42-1>



Apple disclosing takedowns

Starting with the end of this year's report, Apple will start disclosing app takedown requests from govts. <https://dgit.in/jun18-A42-2>

MSI GT75 8RG Gaming Laptop

The new flagship

The MSI GT75 8RG TITAN is a simple upgrade over the previous gen GT75 TITAN and the key change is the inclusion of the Intel 8th Gen CPU (Core i7-8750H), faster RAM, improved cooling system and a couple of software enhancements. With the added features and the updated hardware, one would assume that MSI would bump the price up by a few thousand bucks but NO, the MSI GT75 TITAN 8RG is priced at ₹2,99,990 which makes it cheaper than the previous gen GT75 TITAN by about 30K.

Build Quality

Being a bigger laptop, the MSI GT75 8RG uses plenty of metal to for rigidity. Most laptops tend to use plastic for the display panel backing. That's not the case here. The unit is well cooled, even at peak loads, however, there are exhausts placed towards the sides which makes using a mouse on either side a bit uncomfortable. Thankfully, there are no hotspots on the palm area. Being more of a flagship SKU, the GT75 has enough space inside the body to play around with the positioning of the components. As a result, the touch temperature doesn't spike during CPU intensive workloads. The SSDs which form the RAID volume have their very own heatsink which is a nice touch since some of these NVMe SSDs are known to heat up during sustained workloads. The GT75 is heavy, it clocks in at 4.56 kg and comes with a brick for the power adapter. The Core i9 variant ships with two adapters, so portability is a concern with the GT75 and it's bigger cousin the GT83.

Performance

The MSI GT75 8RG makes use of two Samsung SSDs, in the case the PM961, in RAID 0 to get a 480 GB



volume. There's an additional 1 TB HGST hard drive for everything else. Peak read speeds on the RAID 0 volume top out at around 3.4 GB/s and write speeds clock in at about 2.4 GB/s. These are pretty insane transfer speeds and helps with the fluidity of your experience with the machine.

Gaming

The MSI GT75 8RG packs quite the punch given the combination of an Intel Core i7-8750H with the NVIDIA GTX 1080. And now that we have a 4K panel we can enjoy AAA titles in all their glory but before we move to the gaming benchmarks, let's take a look at the synthetics. We started with PCMark 10 that scored 7319 points and then moved on to 3D Mark where we saw Fire Strike clocking in at 18119, Cloud Gate getting 38621, Sky Diver managed 41859 and the newest of the bunch, Time Spy got 7114.

Overall, we're seeing a marked improvement in the synthetic benchmarks owing to the improved CPU. Now we need to see if the real world gaming benchmarks reflect the same.

The latest from Ubisoft in the FarCry series i.e. Far Cry 5 scored about 118 FPS on high settings while Ghost Recon Wildlands clocked in much lower at 106 FPS. In a slightly older game, The Witcher 3, we got about 138 FPS which is pretty decent overall. With a few careful tweaks, the FPS scores can go up a little and that makes it optimal for a 120 Hz panel. It goes without saying that the GTX 1080 on the MSI GT75 8RG makes high-end gaming quite easy.

Verdict

The MSI GT75 8RG is great for gaming with its GTX 1080 and it packs a wonderful 120 Hz display as well. There isn't a significant overhaul in comparison to the previous generation but what's noteworthy is that MSI added new features and lowered the price a little to bring it down to 2,99,990 which competes with the GTX 1080 MAX-Q laptops that are currently selling in the market. The Zephyrus and the Acer Triton 700 sport 7th Gen CPUs and GTX 1080 graphics cards. Given that they are MAX-Q laptops, they run slightly underpowered hardware and that's where the GT75 gains an edge. However, all things considered, the MAX-Q laptops are way better in terms of portability which is what laptops were made for in the first place. So given the choice, we'd go for a MAX-Q laptop since they're both priced the same.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

PROCESSOR: Intel Core i7-8750H | PLATFORM: CM246 | RAM: 16 GB 2667 MHz | SCREEN SIZE: 17.3-inches 120Hz | SCREEN RESOLUTION: 3840x2160 | GPU: GTX 1080 8 GB GDDR5X | SSD: 480 GB RAID 0 | HDD: HGST 1TB | BATTERY: 90 Whr | AC ADAPTER: 330 W | WEIGHT: 4.56 Kg

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